Creating a New Application

When you install the Rails framework, you also get a new command-line tool, `rails`, that's used to construct each new Rails application you write.

Why do we need a tool to do this? Why can't we just hack away in our favorite editor and create the source for our application from scratch? Well, we could just hack. After all, a Rails application is just Ruby source code. But Rails also does a lot of magic behind the curtain to get our applications to work with a minimum of explicit configuration. To get this magic to work, Rails needs to find all the various components of your application. As you'll see later (in *Where Things Go*), this means we need to create a specific directory structure, slotting the code we write into the appropriate places. The `rails` command creates this directory structure for us and populates it with some standard Rails code.

To create your first Rails application, pop open a shell window and navigate to a place in your filesystem where you want to create your application's directory structure. In our example, we'll be creating our projects in a directory called `work`. In that directory, use the `rails` command to create an application called `demo`. Be slightly careful here—if you have an existing directory called `demo`, you'll be asked if you want to overwrite any existing files. (Note that if you want to specify which Rails version to use, as described in *Choosing a Rails Version*, now is the time to do so.)

```
rubys> cd work
work> rails new demo
create
create  README.md
create  Rakefile
create  .ruby-version
  :      :      :
remove  config/initializers/cors.rb
remove  config/initializers/new_framework_defaults_8_0.rb
```